was able to spread Catholicism into modern-day Poland, the Czech Republic, Bohemia and other areas. In 800, Charlemagne was declared the Holy Roman Emperor but his heirs continued to squabble amongst themselves after he died.

During the 9th century, there was a sharp decline of the Carolingian empire. It was at this time that the Vikings and the Normans launched raids in Italy, Spain and France. Also, the Islamic navy had established centers in Sicily, northwest France and Apulia. It was at Sicily and Apulia that the Normans were able to defeat the Islamic invaders, which historians believe to be the origin of the Crusades. These developments caused the Europeans to remobilize and reconsider their surroundings. The idea of feudalism appeared and explained the individual bond between vassals. Bishops provided ethical supervision, justice and management of law to help build a more orderly society.

From the early seventh century, the Church extended its political hierarchy and broke away from Constantinople. There was a difference between the doctrines of the Church and those that were being taught at Constantinople. Monasticism emerged and stimulated the Church to grow and expand. The new reforms originated in the Middle East during the 9th and 10th centuries. The Church wanted to continue traditional lessons and reduce the amount of hostilities throughout the continent but still encourage taking back of the Middle East from the Islamic forces. Monks became new popes and the Church was able to gain a strong foothold in Europe.

The intricate political chaos experienced in Europe started to simplify during the mid-tenth century when the post-Carolingian upper classes chose Conrad and Henry I as the new kings. The duchies that refused to hand over power were overthrown. Ruling between 936 and 973 CE, Otto I overthrew the duchies in the eastern regions and defeated the Magyars in 955 CE in the area known today as Hungary. He attacked the Slavs and was successful in conquering them such that the Slavs changed their religion and became Christians. He was named emperor in 996 CE with the approval of Pope Gregory V who was his cousin. The spiritual and political influence of the Church continued to expand. At the same time, medieval France was